

/reverse

Reverse-engineer a GitHub repo: `/reverse <owner/repo | URL> [--tech ] [--create ]`

Overview

`/reverse` fetches a public repo's metadata, root file tree, and README via the GitHub API, then asks the currently selected LLM model to generate a synthetic creation prompt that could have produced that repo.

The generated prompt is useful as a seed for scaffolding a similar project: copy it into the message window, feed it to another command, or chain it straight into spec creation with the `--create <name>` option.

Synthesis runs on the currently selected model, so switch to the model you want before running the command.

Syntax

```
/reverse <owner/repo | URL>
/reverse <owner/repo | URL> --tech <stack>
/reverse <owner/repo | URL> --tech <stack> --create <name>
```

Options

Form	Description
<code>/reverse <owner/repo></code>	owner/repo shorthand, e.g. <code>ratatui/ratatui</code>
<code>/reverse <URL></code>	full GitHub URL, e.g. <code>https://github.com/ratatui/ratatui</code>
<code>--tech <stack></code>	constrain the synthetic prompt to the named technology stack
<code>--create <name></code>	chain into <code>/spec create</code> , auto-generating a spec named <code><name></code> from the reverse-engineered prompt

Both identifier forms are accepted by the same command; pick whichever you have at hand.

Examples

Plain owner/repo shorthand:

```
/reverse ratatui/ratatui
```

Full GitHub URL:

```
/reverse https://github.com/ratatui/ratatui
```

Constrain the synthetic prompt to a Rust stack:

```
/reverse tokio-rs/axum --tech rust
```

Constrain the stack and chain straight into spec creation:

```
/reverse tokio-rs/axum --tech rust --create config-svc
```

Output

The message window shows repo fetch progress first, then the generated prompt. With `--create <name>`, the spec creation output follows the prompt.

Workflow

1. Fetch - the GitHub API supplies the repo's metadata, root file tree, and README.
2. Synthesise - the currently selected LLM model turns that material into a synthetic creation prompt that could have produced the repo.
3. Chain (optional) - `--create <name>` hands the prompt to `/spec create`, which auto-generates a spec named `<name>`.

Notes

- `--tech <stack>` only steers synthesis; it does not change what is fetched.
- `--create <name>` names the spec produced by the chained `/spec create` run.
- The fetch step uses the GitHub API, so the target repo must be public.

Related

- `/spec create` - the command `--create` chains into
- `/new` - scaffold a project directly